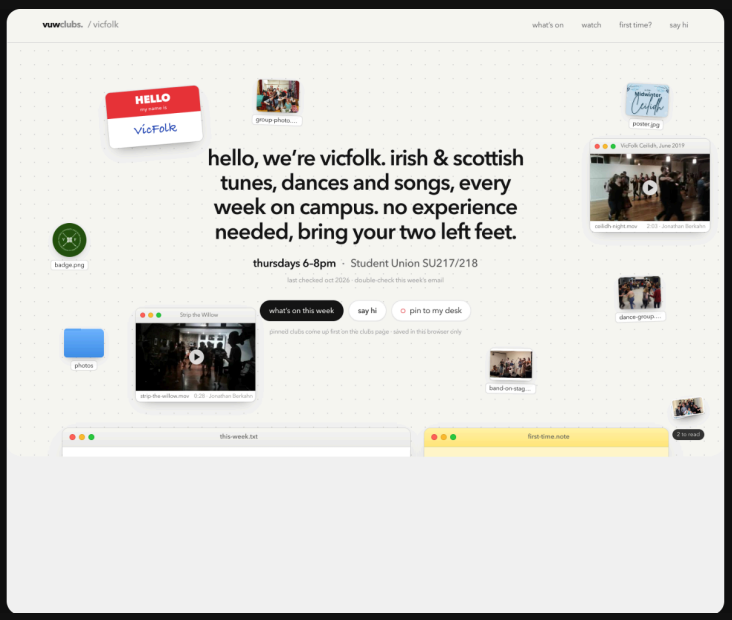
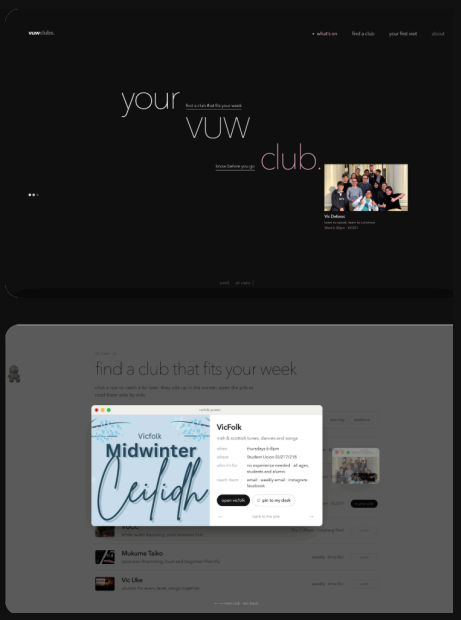
SWEN303 · GROUP 4 · ITERATION 1

vuw clubs.

From “I’d like to come” to “I know where to go”.
Before, during and after design.





A website that helps Victoria University of Wellington students turn interest in a club into a plan: when it meets, what happens there, and how to turn up for the first time. This document covers the research behind Iteration 1, the design that came out of it, and what three user tests and a heuristic evaluation found.

T1
Find an activity that fits my available time

T2
Decide whether a particular session suits me

T3
Prepare for my first visit

T4
Check the latest arrangements before attending again

T5
Explore an activity I’ve heard about

01 / BEFORE DESIGN

Three interviews and a directory walkthrough · five observations · personas for Liv, Theo and Ben · a journey map with a hypothesised emotion curve · five user tasks.

02 / DURING DESIGN

Tasks mapped to three places and a guide · four user flows · a feature map · six wireframes · prototype sections · four design points · a component guide.

03 / AFTER DESIGN

Three user tests · task results · twelve findings · Nielsen heuristic evaluation · recommendations for Iteration 2.

Rui Meng Tong · Iteration 1 prototype built 10 October 2026 · React, TypeScript, Vite

CONTENTS

What is in this section

01 / BEFORE DESIGN

Research approach and what the interviews showed

Personas: Liv, Theo and Ben

Scenarios: As-is, To-be, and Evaluation

Journey map with hypothesised emotion curve

User tasks and who they come from

02 / DURING DESIGN

Overview: from five tasks to three places

User flow T1: find a club that fits the week

User flow T2 + T3: decide and prepare

User flow T4 and the golem

Functional organisation: feature map

Wireframes: six screens, desktop and mobile

Prototype sections: how the screens connect

Design point 01: time comes first

Design point 02: the pile replaces the tabs

Design point 03: the club page as a desktop

Design point 04: someone to ask

Component guide: Iteration 1 colour and type

Component guide: parts

Feature-to-task summary and questions taken into testing

03 / AFTER DESIGN

User testing: three sessions

Task results

Twelve findings (F1–F12)

Nielsen heuristic evaluation of Iteration 1

Recommendations: what to keep and what to fix

Tools, AI use and sources

BEFORE DESIGN / RESEARCH

The interest is there. The practical details are not.

I interviewed three students, Liv, Theo and Ben, about how they find clubs, choose what to attend and keep going. Each interview ended with a walkthrough of the current university club directory. Five observations shaped Iteration 1; two more informed it less directly.

OBSERVATION 1

Interest does not become attendance without practical details

"I already know I would like to come; I need to know where to go."

Liv, directory walkthrough. She knew the folk club since high school but joined halfway through first year "because I did not know which day it met or where."

OBSERVATION 2

Available time decides which clubs are even on the table

"Why I cannot sort by when they meet."

Liv wanted course-finder-style filters: "first find clubs I can attend, then read about those." Theo dropped a club that clashed with a study workshop.

OBSERVATION 3

Students need to know what this particular session involves

"It says what we will do and which room we will use."

Liv on the weekly club email. Theo was unsure "whether they were meeting that week", and found beginner guides "pinned six months ago".

OBSERVATION 4

Pictures form the first impression

"I feel less engaged and would like to see an image."

Theo, on a page with no images. Ben: "not especially exciting as advertising." Liv joined her first club after "funny flyers around campus."

OBSERVATION 5

Privacy and platform choice affect whether people engage

"That would make continuing difficult for me."

Theo, on being told "to look on Instagram", which he does not use. He would hesitate if member profiles were public. Liv: "I am more of an in-person person."

ALSO NOTED

Friends are a way in, and asking comes before searching

"I would first ask whether anyone I know has that interest."

Ben joined the Filipino club "because my friends were there". Students arrive with a club name from a friend or a flyer. This shaped the golem and T5, but less directly.

Source note: quotations come from the cleaned interview transcripts, which are edited for readability and are not verbatim. Parts of Ben's interview were not captured clearly; his request for more visual elements is my recollection, not a recorded quote.

Same clubs, three different first questions

Liv asks “when?”, Theo asks “what exactly?”, Ben asks “who else is going?”. Each persona summarises one interviewee; they are not statistical segments.

Liv

The Selective Participant

“I’m trying to find clubs that I can go to.”

ABOUT

22, final year of linguistics and computer science. In a folk music club; enjoys singing and dancing. Fits activities around study.

NEEDS

Visible meeting times and places; a way to filter by available time; what each session involves; clear expectations about experience.

PAIN POINTS

- Meetings clash with coursework.
- Descriptions skip when and where.
- “Beginner” sessions can assume skills she lacks.

TRAITS

Talkative · face to face · chooses sessions by content

TASKS

T1 · T2 · T4

Theo

The Advance Planner

“Just practical information, really.”

ABOUT

28, third-year software engineering; previously studied contemporary music and worked in retail. Explores clubs before the trimester.

NEEDS

Published schedules; beginner and joining information; stable resources outside chat history; essentials without Instagram; control over disclosure.

PAIN POINTS

- Unclear weekly or study-break plans.
- Guides buried in old messages.
- Pressure to share personal details.

TRAITS

Plans ahead · browses broadly, then narrows · warms up over time

TASKS

T1 · T3 · T4

Ben

The Social Explorer

“Even just the people there can make any environment enjoyable.”

ABOUT

21, into dance, music, fashion and sport. Former class rep who has tried several clubs, usually through friends.

NEEDS

More visual context for the activity; clear time, place and joining information; chances to go with familiar people.

PAIN POINTS

- Pages that make a flat first impression.
- Searching a website feels less natural than asking someone.

TRAITS

Starts conversations · values shared company · varied interests

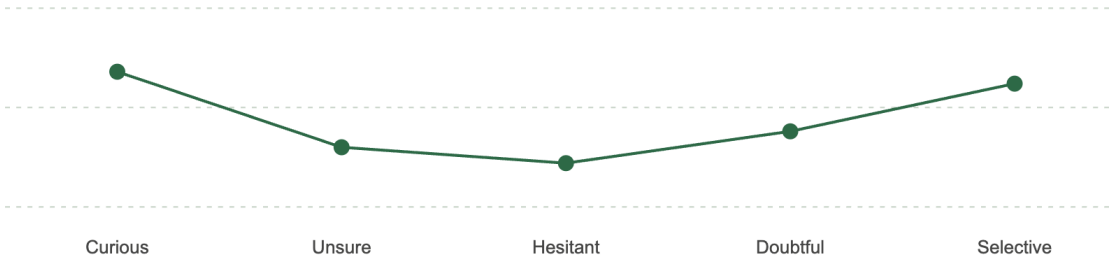
TASKS

T2 · T3 · T5

BEFORE DESIGN / JOURNEY MAP

Confidence drops between “interested” and “there”

A proposed journey from first interest to a second visit, built from the three interviews. The emotion curve is a hypothesis drawn from what participants said; it is not measured data.

	Explore	Check the fit	Get ready	Check updates	Plan another visit
ACTION	Browse clubs or follow a friend’s suggestion.	Check the time and what this session involves.	Find out where to go and how to join.	Check the latest details before leaving.	Decide whether to return or try something else.
EMOTION Hypothesis only					
FRICTION	What is it actually like?	Does it clash? Can I do it as a beginner?	Room, joining steps and contacts are in different places.	Is it on this week, or paused for study break?	Will the next session suit me?
NEED	Photos and a short line on what people do.	Session times, content and skills needed.	Location and joining steps together.	The current plan, changes easy to spot.	Upcoming sessions with content and times.
ITERATION 1 RESPONSE	Poster trail on the home hero; club videos and photos first.	Day and time filters; next meeting on every row; this-week.txt.	Meeting line with room; first-time.note; say-hi.mail.	this-week.txt with “last checked”; pile saved in the browser.	coming-up.ics; the pile to compare again.

Emotion labels follow the interviews: Liv was put off by time clashes and “beginner” sessions that were not, Theo by not knowing if a meeting was on, Liv re-engaged once the weekly email let her choose sessions.

BEFORE DESIGN / USER TASKS

Five tasks carry the journey into the design

Each task is phrased from the student's side and linked to the journey stage and the personas whose interviews it comes from.

T1	**Find an activity that fits my available time** Liv: "first find clubs I can attend, then read about those." Theo plans clubs around labs.	**Liv · Theo** Explore · Check the fit
T2	**Decide whether a particular session suits me** Liv skips sessions she cannot take part in; Ben and Theo want to see what it looks like first.	**Liv · Theo · Ben** Check the fit
T3	**Prepare for my first visit** "I need to know where to go." Room, what to bring, how to join, without Instagram.	**Liv · Theo · Ben** Get ready
T4	**Check the latest arrangements before attending again** Theo: "whether they were meeting that week". Liv relies on the weekly email.	**Liv · Theo** Check updates
T5	**Explore an activity I've heard about** Ben hears about clubs from people first; Liv from "funny flyers". Either way they arrive with a name and want to see what it is.	**Ben** Explore

Task × persona

#	TASK	LIV	THEO	BEN	JOURNEY STAGE
T1	Find an activity that fits my available time	●	●		Explore, Check the fit
T2	Decide whether a particular session suits me	●	●	●	Check the fit
T3	Prepare for my first visit	●	●	●	Get ready
T4	Check the latest arrangements before attending again	●	●		Check updates, Plan another visit
T5	Explore an activity I've heard about			●	Explore

Five tasks, three places, one guide

Iteration 1 groups the tasks into three places on the site. A stone golem on the home list connects them. Solid lines are the main support; dashed lines are partial.



HOME LIST

Every club with its next meeting on the row, weekday and time-of-day filters, and a search box. Clubs with no published time stay in the list, dimmed.

THE PILE

Clubs caught from the list collect in a corner and open side by side, so times can be compared without tabs.

CLUB PAGE

One page per club, laid out as a desktop of videos, photos and files. Each file answers one question from the journey map.

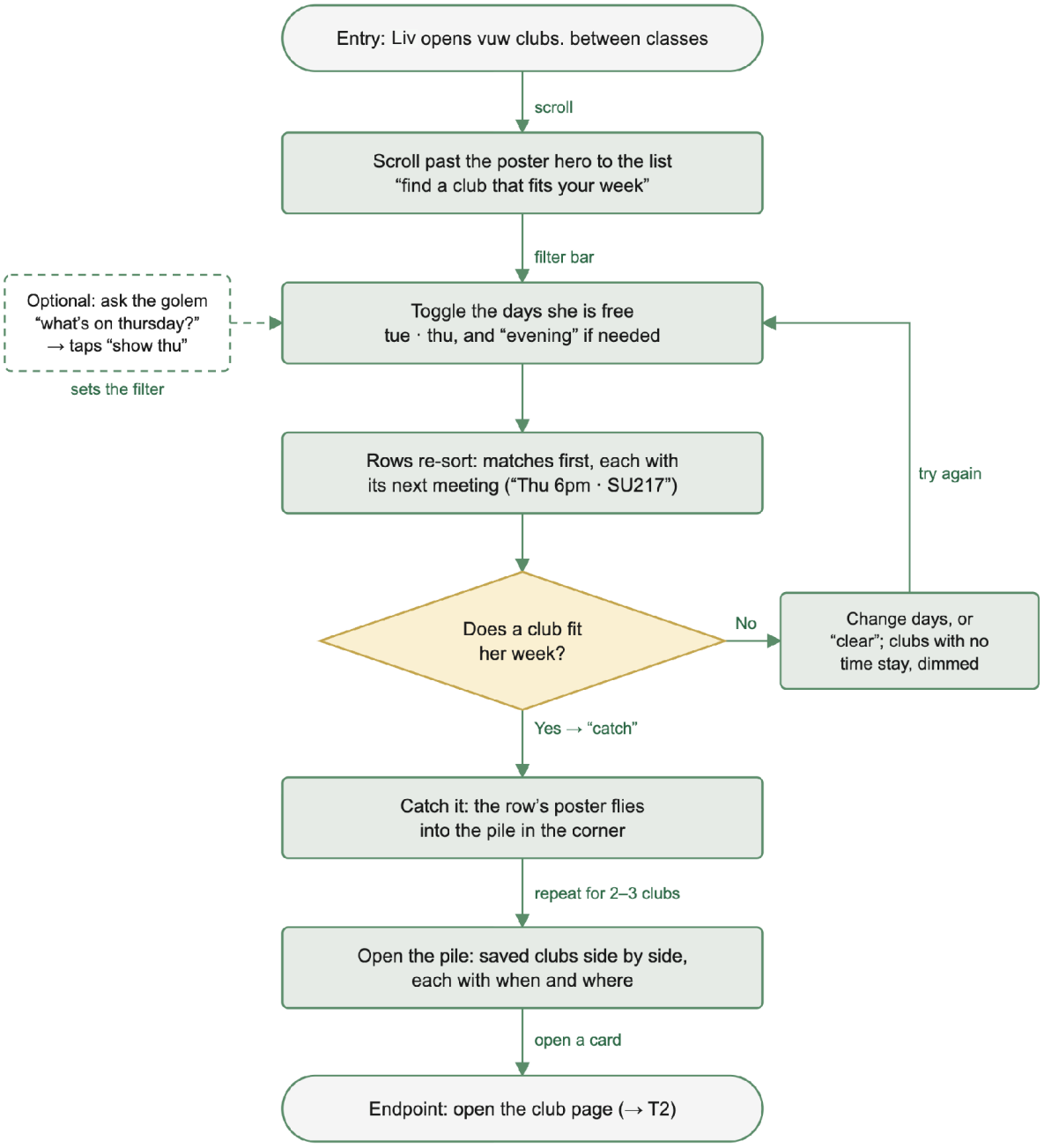
STONE GOLEM

A character who answers quick questions from the same club data, sets a day filter, opens pages and catches clubs.

T5 starts from a name the student already has. Name search finds the club, and its page leads with videos and photos. Iteration 1 shows no members or friends on purpose, because that conflicts with observation 5.

Which clubs can she actually go to?

Scenario: Liv has twenty minutes between classes. She is free on Tuesday and Thursday evenings and wants a short list before reading about anything.



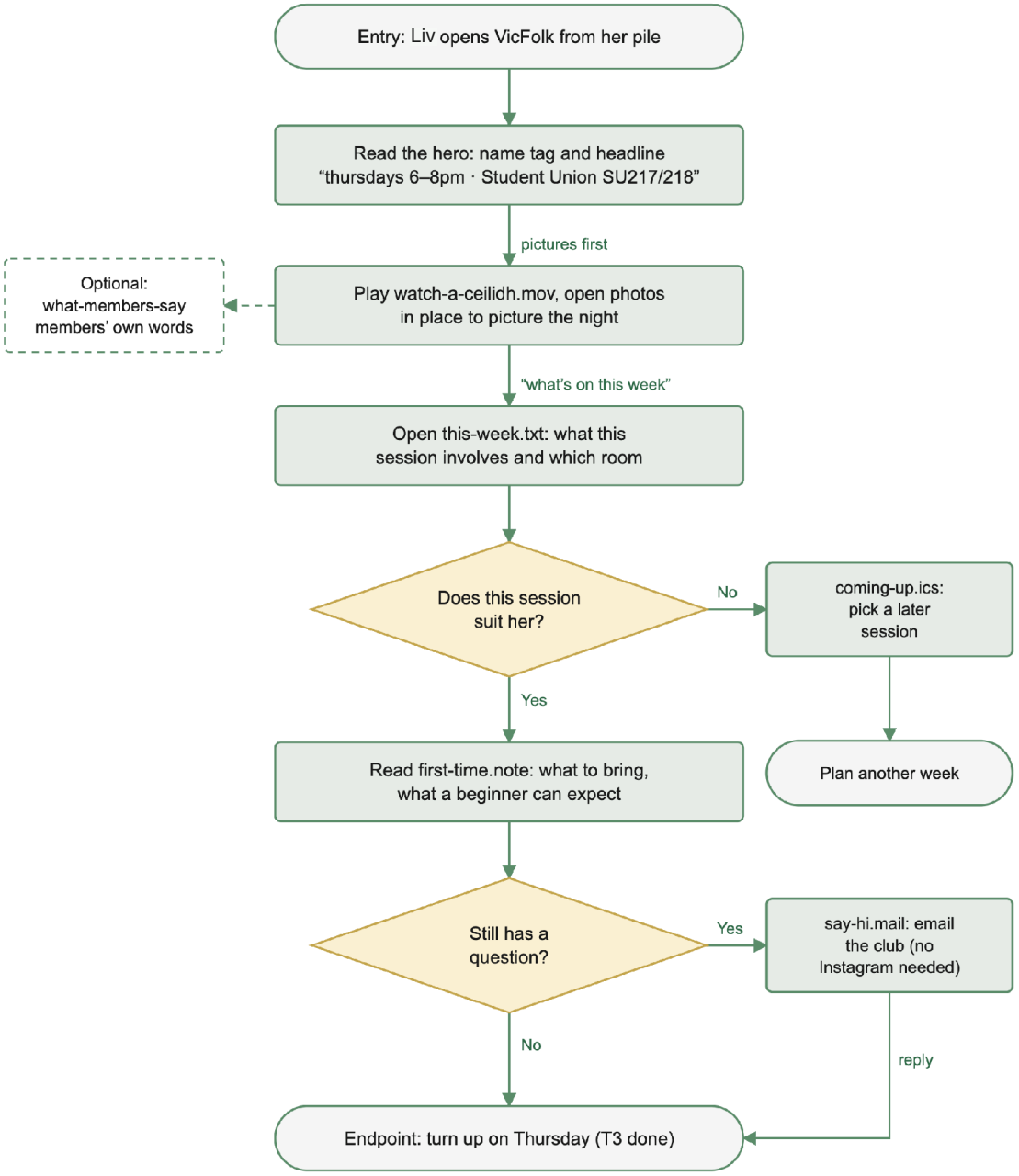
Rounded ends: entry and endpoint · Rectangles: screen state or action · Diamonds: decision · Dashed: optional branch

Time first, interest second

The flow follows the order Liv described: filter by when, then read. Clubs that have not published a time never disappear; they sink and dim, so a missing time reads as missing information rather than “no match”. Screens: pp. 14–16.

Is this Thursday for her, and how does she turn up?

Scenario: Liv has VicFolk in her pile. She wants to see what a night looks like, check this week's plan, and know what a beginner should bring.

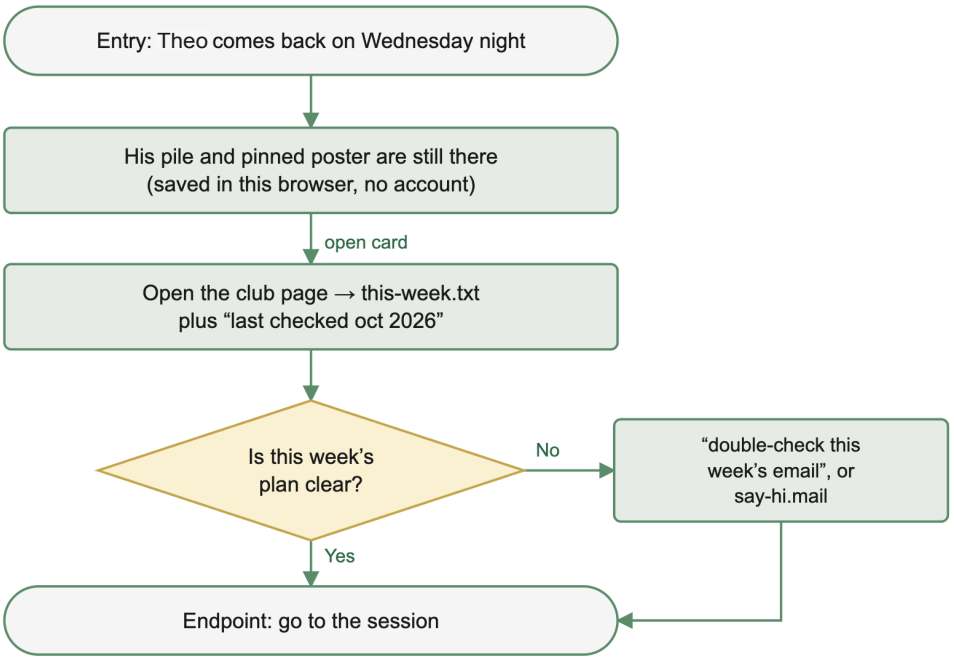


Rounded ends: entry and endpoint · Rectangles: screen state or action · Diamonds: decision · Dashed: optional branch

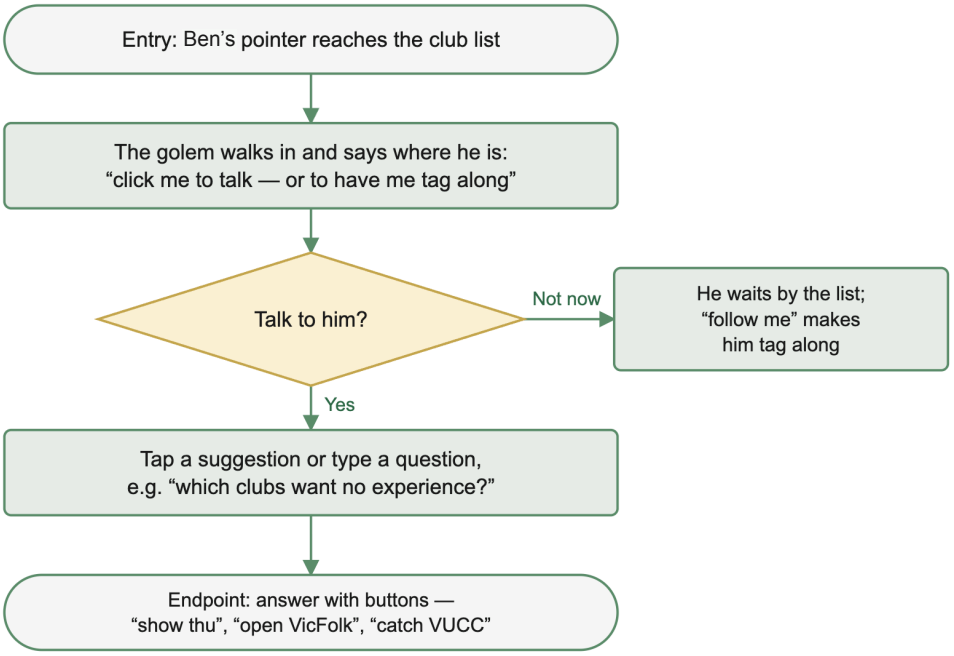
Every box after the hero is one window on the club page, so the flow is also a reading order. Screens: pp. 17–18.

Coming back, and asking instead of searching

T4 · Theo checks before going again



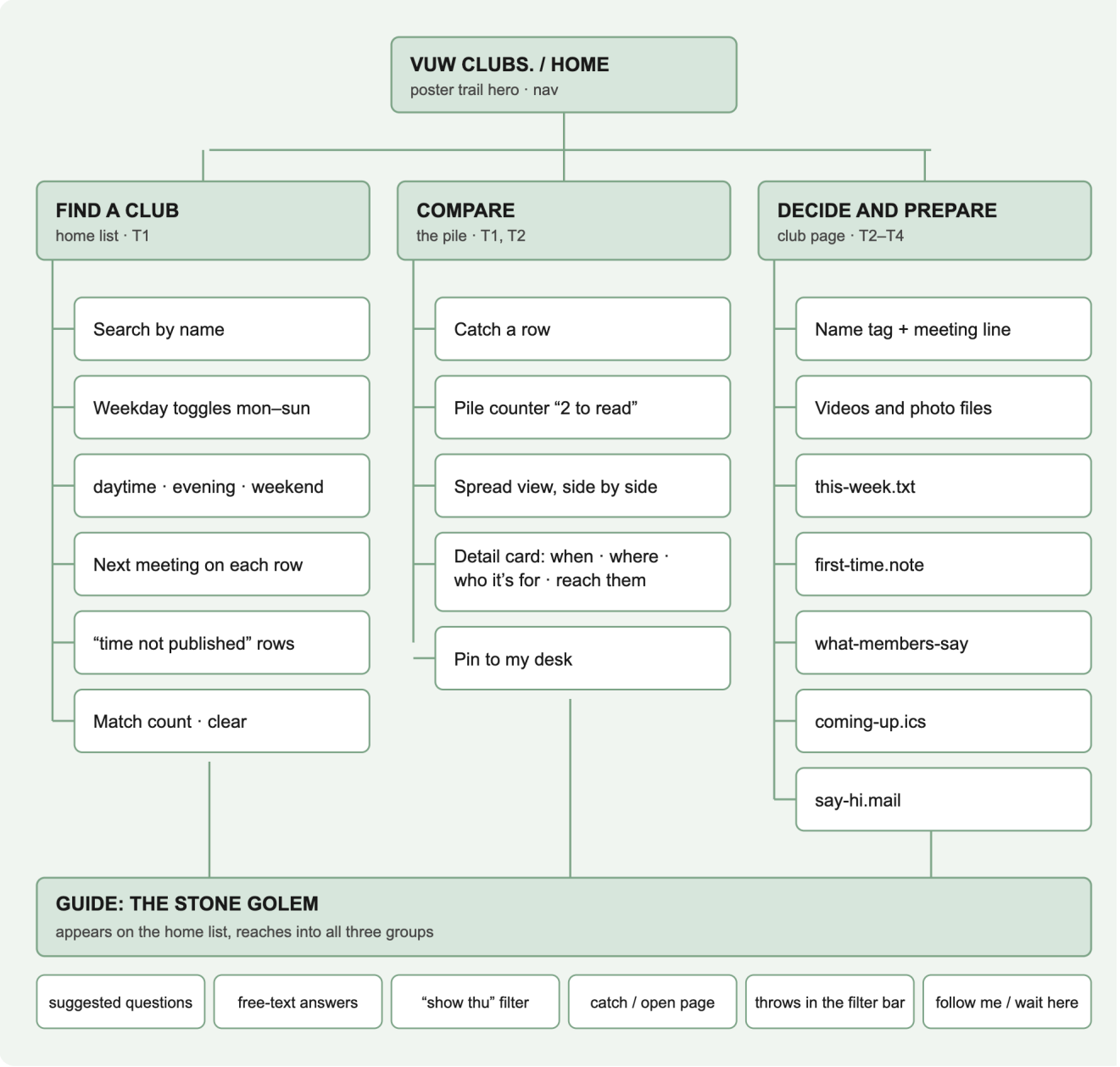
Getting started · Ben asks the golem



The golem does not stand in for a friend; it gives Ben a low-pressure way to ask first. Rounded ends: entry and endpoint · Rectangles: state or action · Diamonds: decision.

How are the features organised?

The flows show how students act. This map shows how the features are grouped; the wireframes on the next page show where they sit on screen.

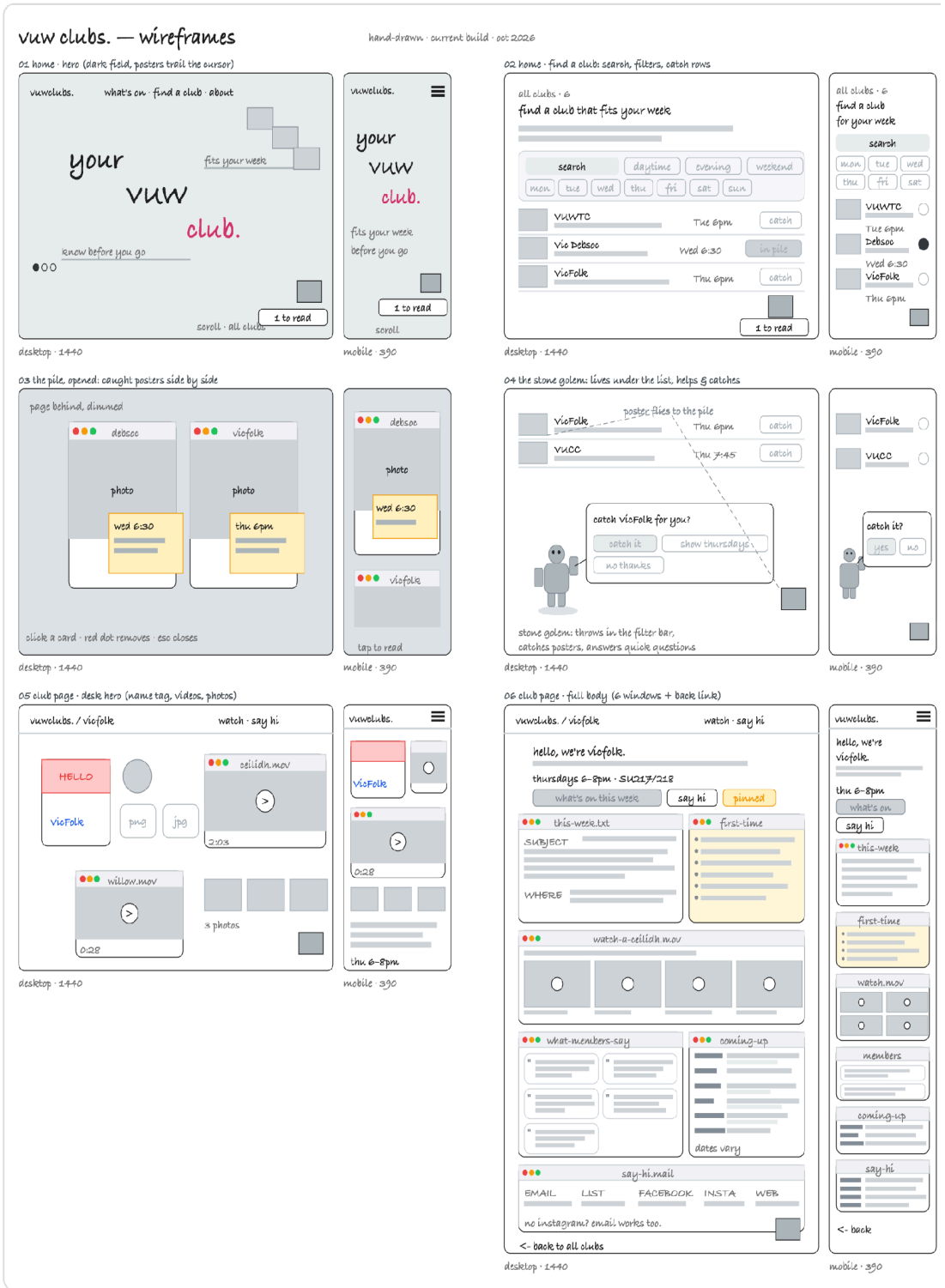


Reading the prototype

Home and finding: pp. 13–14. Golem: p. 15. The pile: p. 16. Club pages: pp. 17–18. Mobile: p. 19.

Six screens, desktop and mobile

Drawn in Excalidraw before the build, each at 1440 px and 390 px wide: home hero, home list, pile opened, golem, club page hero, club page body.



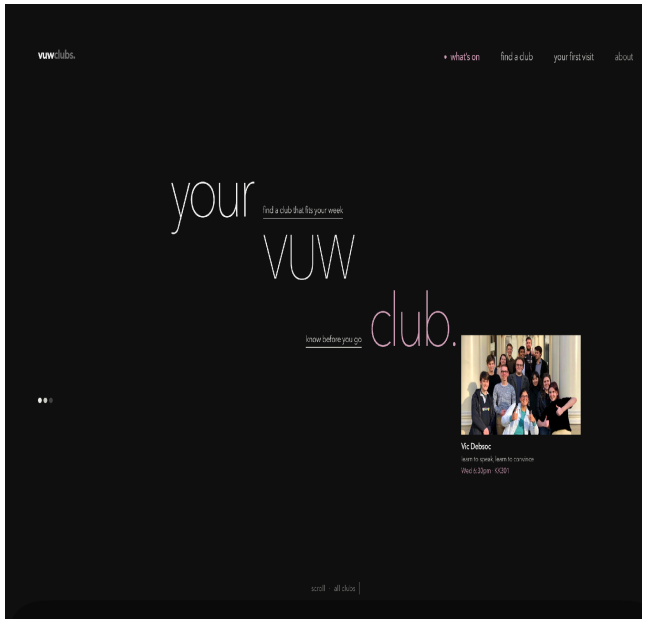
Some wording changed during the build: the hero heading became “your VUW club.”, and the golem’s prompts became questions such as “what’s on thursday?”.

HOME / PAGE RELATIONSHIPS 01

Posters first, then the list

The hero shows clubs as posters that trail the cursor; scrolling down reaches every club with its time.

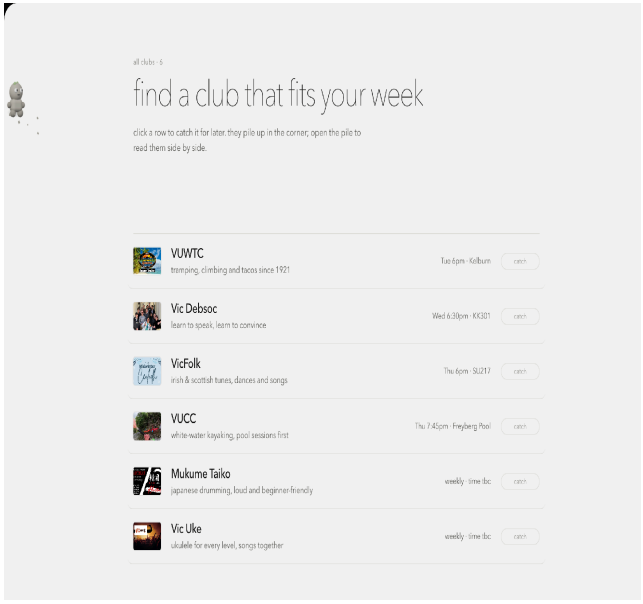
Home hero



Moving the mouse leaves a trail of real club posters. One settles as a card with its name and meeting time.

→ scroll

Home list



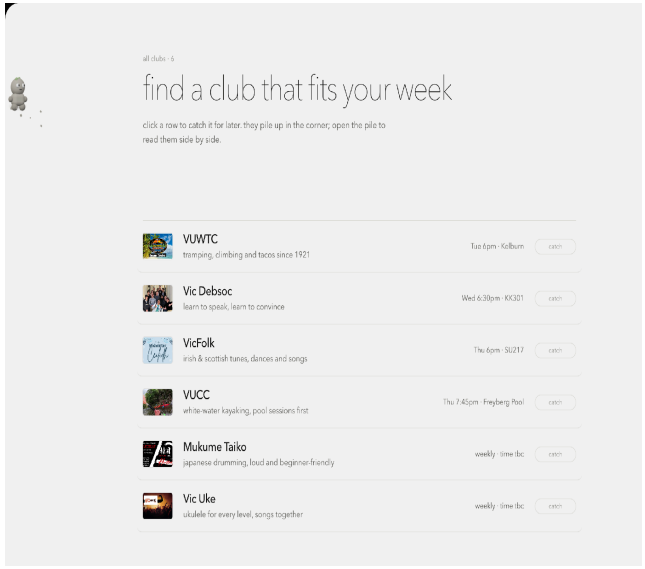
“find a club that fits your week”: name, one line and next meeting on every row, with a “catch” button.

FIND A CLUB / PAGE RELATIONSHIPS 02

Narrow by day and time of day

One bar holds name search, mon–sun and daytime / evening / weekend. Toggles combine.

All six clubs



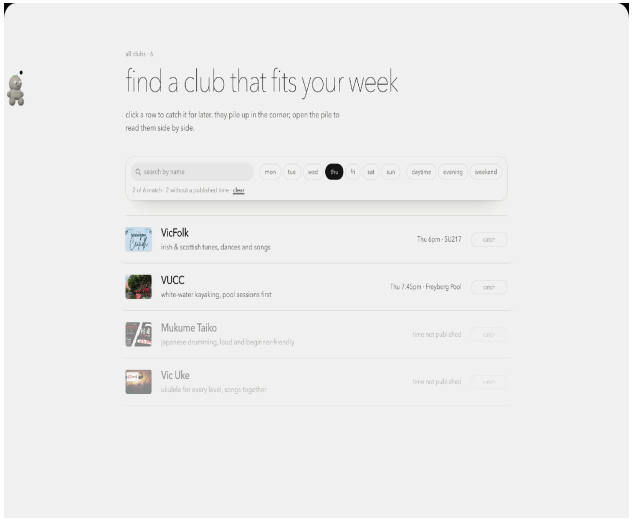
The list starts unfiltered, sorted by the next meeting.

→

tap “thu”

Thursday only

“2 of 6 match · 2 without a publis



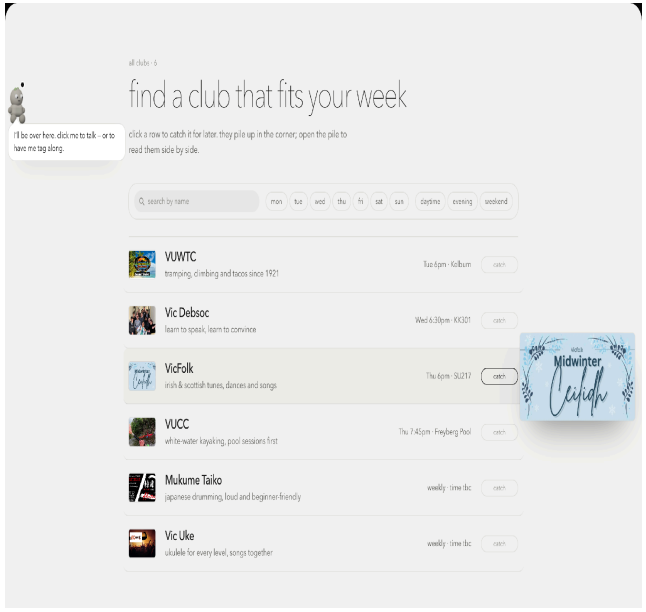
hed time · clear”. Clubs with no time drop below, dimmed and labelled “time not published”.

GUIDE / PAGE RELATIONSHIPS 03

The golem waits beside the list

He appears when the pointer reaches the list, says where he is, and opens a chat when clicked.

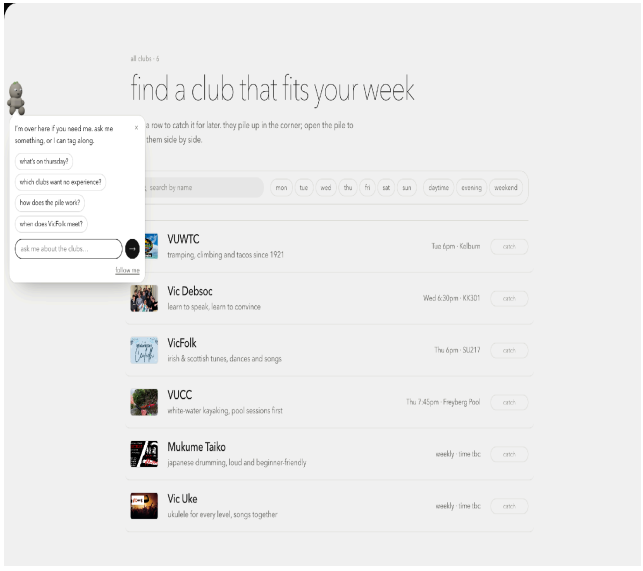
He arrives



“I’ll be over here. click me to talk — or to have me tag along.” By default he stays put.

→ click

Ask him something



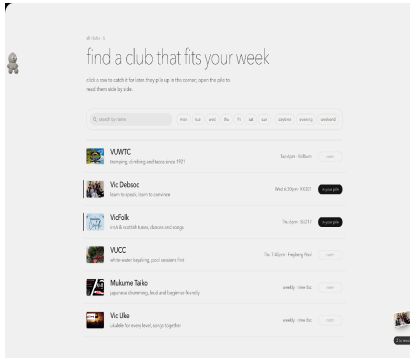
Suggestions: “what’s on thursday?”, “which clubs want no experience?”, “how does the pile work?”, “when does VicFolk meet?”. “follow me” makes him tag along.

COMPARE / PAGE RELATIONSHIPS 04

Catch, pile, compare

Caught clubs fly to a pile in the corner. Opening it spreads them out; one card opens for details.

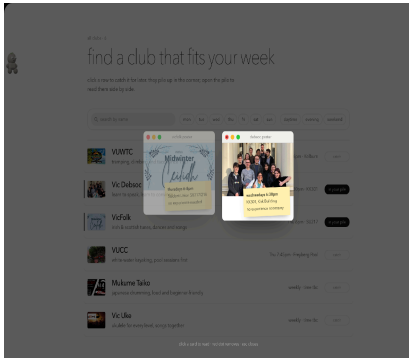
Two caught



Rows read “in your pile”; the pile says “2 to read”.

open pile →

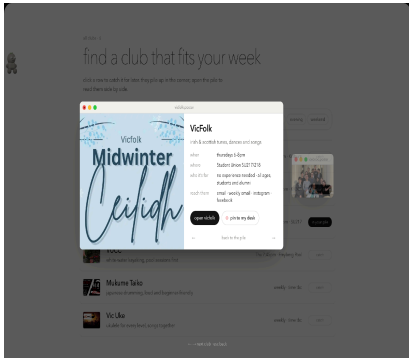
Side by side



Each poster carries a yellow note with when and where.

click a card →

One club



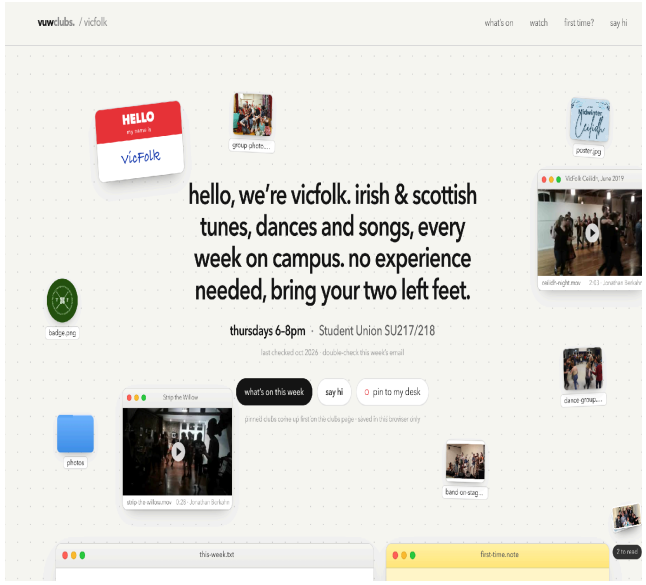
when · where · who it’s for · reach them, then “open vicfolk” or “pin to my desk”.

CLUB PAGE / PAGE RELATIONSHIPS 05

A club page that opens like a desktop

The top answers who, when and where; below it, windows each answer one question.

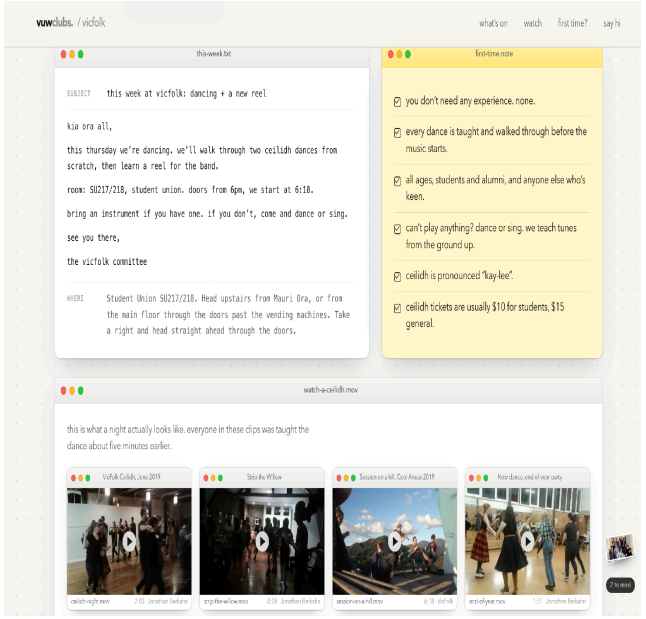
VicFolk hero



Name tag, headline, “thursdays 6–8pm · Student Union SU217/218”, and the club’s own videos and photos as files.

→ “what’s on this week”

The windows



this-week.txt and first-time.note sit side by side, so the plan and the beginner notes are read together.

CLUB PAGE / PAGE RELATIONSHIPS 06

One structure, different clubs

Every club page uses the same six windows, filled with that club's own public content.

VicFolk, full page



VUWTC, full page



Reading order

WINDOW	QUESTION IT ANSWERS
this-week.txt	What is on this week, and where?
first-time.note	What should a newcomer bring a
watch-a-ceilidh.mov	What does it look and sound like?
what-members-say	What is it like, in members' words
coming-up.ics	What is on later in the year?
say-hi.mail	How do I get in touch or join?

VUWTC names its windows for its own content (for example trip-vibes.mov, in-their-words.txt). All six clubs use real information from their public pages and videos.

MOBILE / PAGE RELATIONSHIPS 07

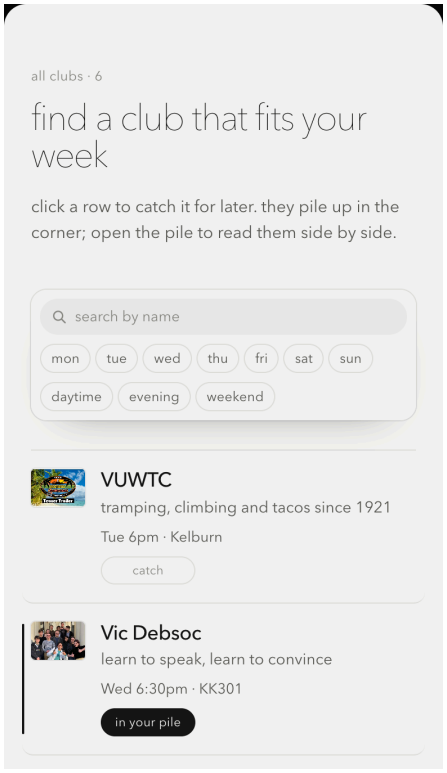
The same order on a phone

At 390 px the hero, list and club page stack into one column; the time stays on every row.

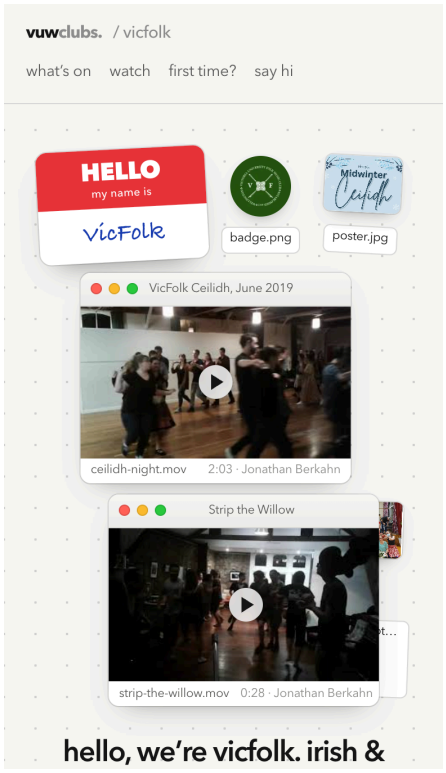
Home hero



Club list



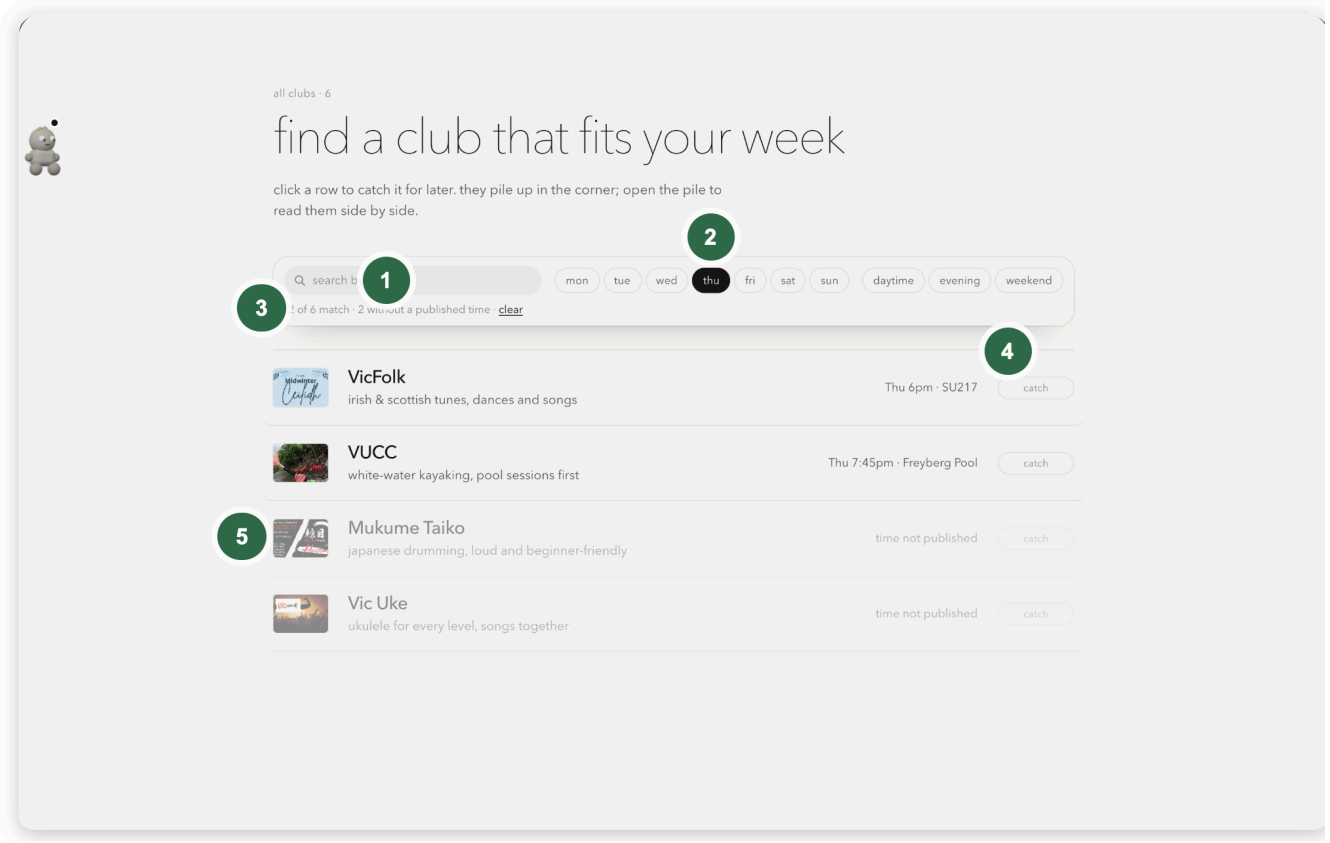
Club page



DESIGN POINT 01 · T1 · LIV

“Why can’t I sort by when they meet?”

> *Liv is between classes and wants to know which clubs she could actually attend, before reading about any of them.*



1 **Name search** sits in the same bar, for students who already know the club.

2 **Weekday and time-of-day toggles** combine: “tue or thu, evening” is three taps.

3 **Match count** says how many clubs fit and how many have no time, with “clear”.

4 **Next meeting on the row**: “Thu 6pm · SU217”, readable before opening a page.

5 **Missing times dim, not disappear**: “time not published” is shown as missing information.

EVIDENCE

Observation 2. Liv: “first find clubs I can attend, then read about those”, and her comparison with the course finder. Theo plans clubs around labs.

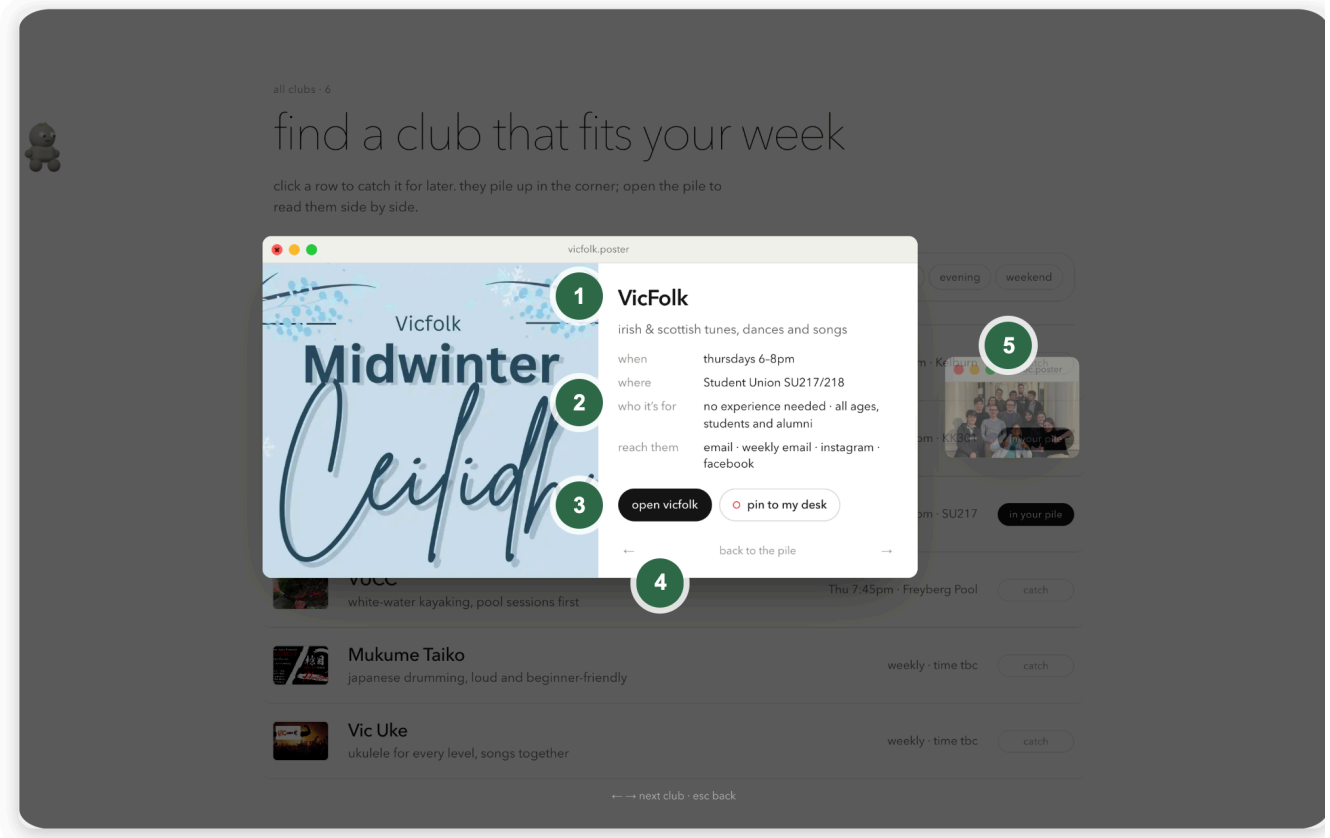
OPEN QUESTION

Clubs whose time changes week to week are not handled yet; they show their usual slot only.

DESIGN POINT 02 · T1, T2 · THEO

“I open anything vaguely interesting in a new tab”

> *Theo works down the list, opens possible clubs in tabs, then goes back through the tabs to narrow them down.*



1 **Poster plus facts**: the club’s own poster beside when and where it meets.

2 **Who it’s for** and **reach them**: “no experience needed”, email before Instagram.

3 **Two next steps**: “open vicfolk” for the full page, or “pin to my desk”.

4 **Back to the pile**, or ← → to step through the other caught clubs.

5 **The rest of the pile** stays visible behind, so nothing is lost.

EVIDENCE

Theo’s tab habit and his wish to “disclose only what is required”: the pile lives in the browser and needs no account.

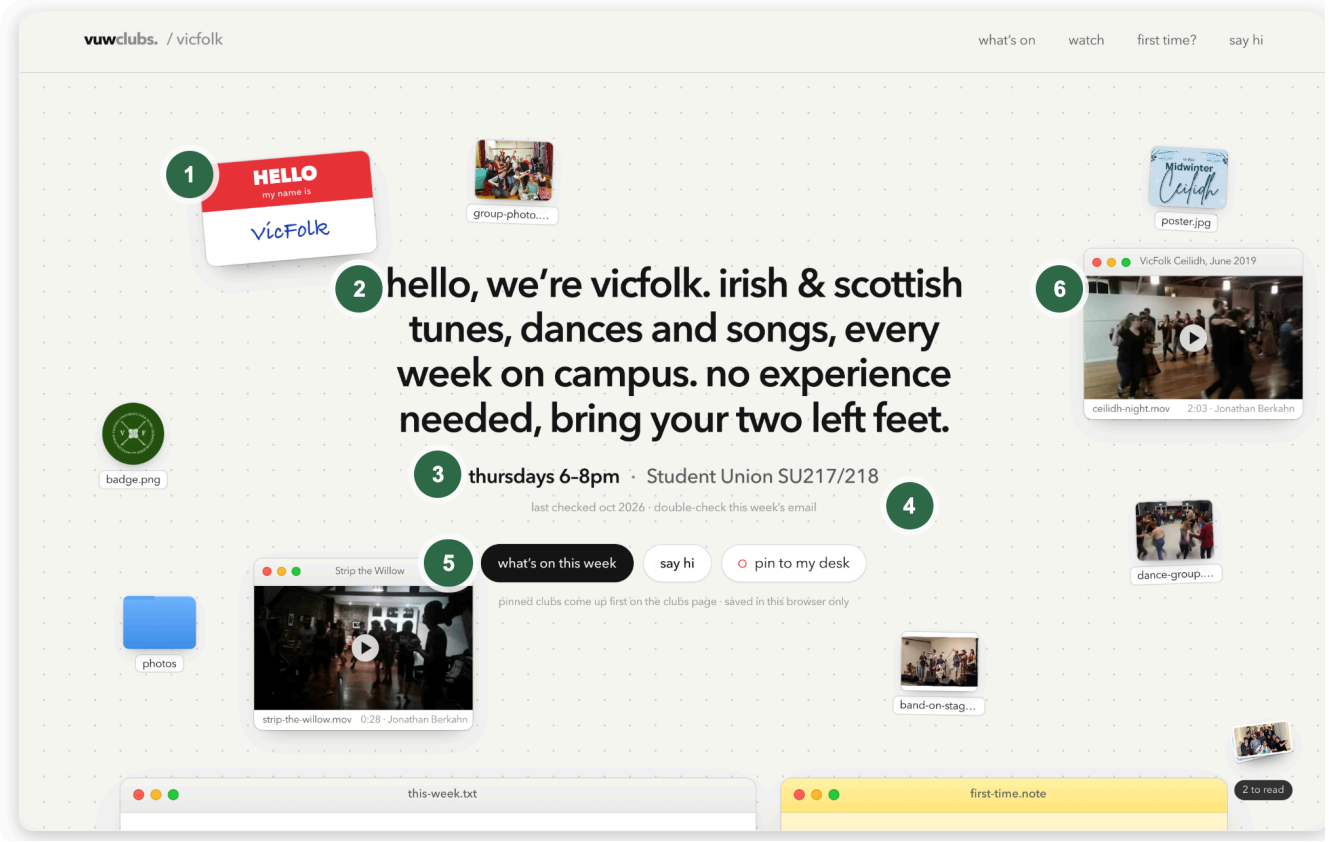
OPEN QUESTION

“Catch” fits the playful home page, but may not explain itself. This went into testing.

DESIGN POINT 03 · T2, T3, T4 · LIV

“I already know I would like to come; I need to know where to go”

> *Liv has found a club she likes. She needs this week’s plan, the room, and what a beginner should expect.*



1 **Name tag** “HELLO, my name is VicFolk”: friendly, and clearly the club speaking.

2 **Headline** says what happens and who it is for: “no experience needed”.

3 **Meeting line** with day, time and room, the answer Liv was missing.

4 **“last checked oct 2026”**, with a nudge to check this week’s email.

5 **Three actions**: what’s on this week, say hi, pin to my desk.

6 **Videos and photos as files**, opened in place: pictures before text (obs. 4).

EVIDENCE

Observations 1, 3 and 4. Below the hero, six windows each answer one journey-map question (p. 18).

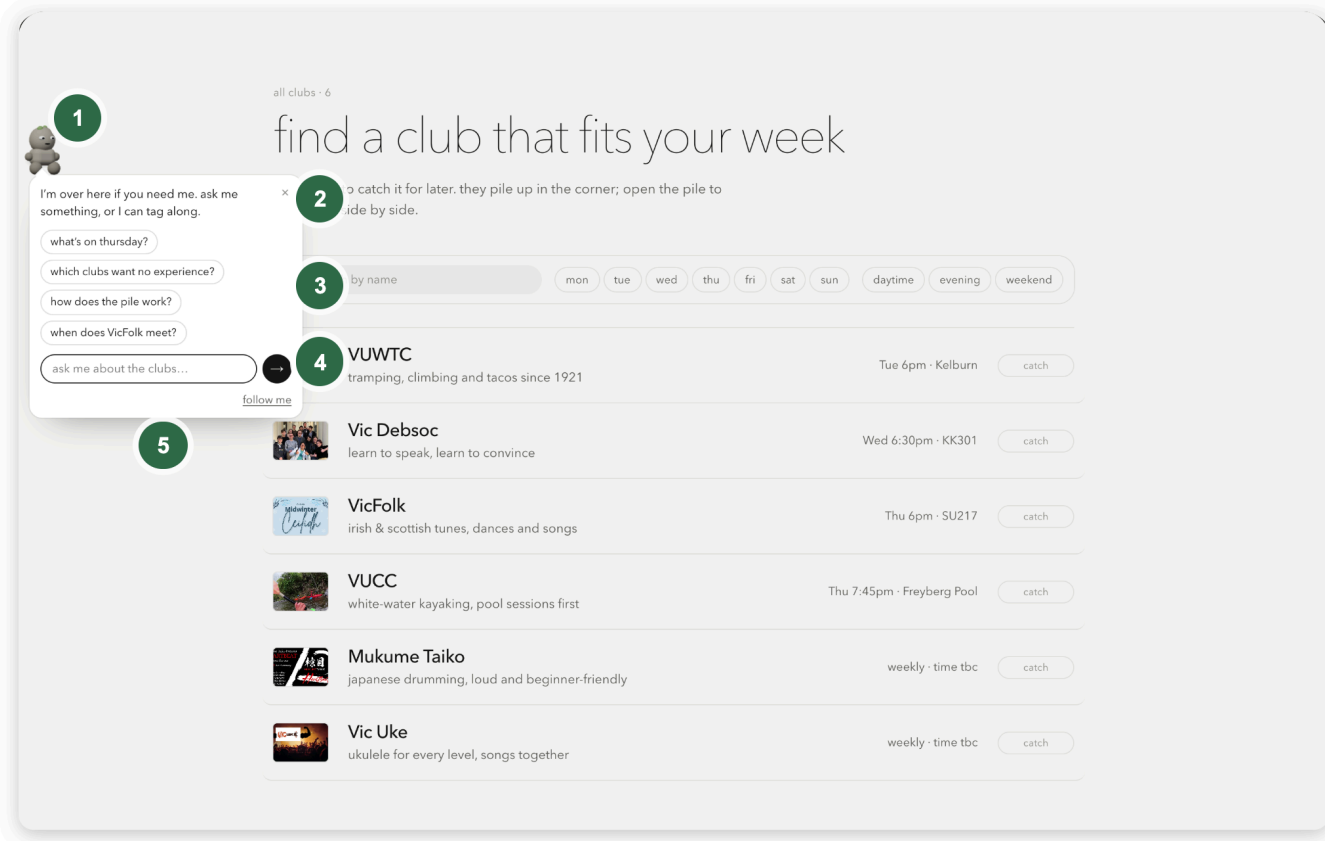
OPEN QUESTION

Are file names such as first-time.note enough to tell the windows apart? Taken into testing.

DESIGN POINT 04 · GETTING STARTED · BEN

“I would first ask whether anyone I know has that interest”

> *Ben would rather ask someone than search a website.*



1 **The stone golem**, a character on the home list rather than a chat icon.

2 **He says where he is** and what he can do, in plain words.

3 **Suggested questions** drawn from the interviews: days, no experience, the pile.

4 **Free text**, answered from the same club data as the list, with buttons such as “show thu”.

5 **“follow me”**: he tags along while scrolling; by default he waits.

EVIDENCE

Ben’s “first ask” habit, and the wish for a more visual, less flat first impression (obs. 4). The first time per session he throws the filter bar into place.

OPEN QUESTION

He is not a person and does not replace a friend. The risk is that he draws more attention than the task; taken into testing.

Iteration 1 colour, type and parts

A quiet paper-and-ink base so club photos and posters carry the colour. Accents are kept for things that need a glance: the name tag, notes and the pile.

Colour



Ink
#141414 · text, active pill

Ink soft
#5C5C5A · secondary text

Ink faint
#8F8F8C · hints, labels

Paper
#F5F5F3 · page background

Paper deep
#EBEBE8 · insets



Window
#FFFFFF · windows, rows

Note
#FFF3B0 · time notes, first-time

Name tag red
#E8333A · HELLO tag, pins

Accent
#D4A2BA · editorial highlight

Hero
#111111 · poster-trail field

Type

Avenir Next Ultra Light · 56 px list heading	find a club that fits your week
Avenir Next Demi · 34 px club headline	hello, we're vicfolk.
Avenir Next Regular · 15 px body, rows	irish & scottish tunes, dances and songs
SF Mono · 11 px file and window names	this-week.txt · first-time.note
Bradley Hand name tag only	VicFolk

Parts, recreated from the build

Each part has one job. The list and pile use pills and rows; the club page uses windows and notes; character comes from the name tag and the golem.

FILTER PILLS

mon tue **thu** evening

Off: outline. On: ink fill. Days and times combine.

CLUB ROW

VicFolk
irish & scottish tunes — Thu 6pm · SU217 — catch

Vic Uke
ukulele for every level — time not published — catch

Time on the right; dimmed when not published.

PILE

VicFolk
in your pile — in your pile

2 to read

Caught rows flip to ink; the badge counts what is waiting.

WINDOW

this-week.txt

this thursday we're dancing.
room: SU217/218, doors from 6pm.

One window, one question. The title is the file name.

NOTE

first-time.note

you don't need any experience. none.

Yellow for newcomer advice and times on pile cards.

NAME TAG AND GOLEM



ask me something, or I can tag along.

Character in two places: the club's tag, the site's guide.

What each feature is for, and what we still needed to learn

FEATURE	T1 FIT MY TIME	T2 SUITS ME	T3 FIRST VISIT	T4 LATEST PLAN	T5 HEARD ABOUT
Home list: name search, day / time filters	●				●
The pile	●	○			
Club page videos and photos		●			●
this-week.txt, coming-up.ics		●		●	
first-time.note		●	●		
say-hi.mail			●		
Stone golem	○	○			○
Shareable club page address					○

● main support · ○ partial support

Questions taken into the first user test

Q1 · THE PILE

Does “catch” explain itself?

Will students know a caught club is saved, and find the pile again without help?

Q2 · CLUB PAGE

Are file names enough to tell the windows apart?

Can a student find this week’s room and the beginner notes without reading every window?

Q3 · THE GOLEM

Does he help, or distract?

Do students use him to get started, or does he draw attention away from the list?

Q4 · T5

Is a name and a few videos enough to get a feel for a club?

Starting from a club someone mentioned, can a student tell quickly whether it is worth a closer look?

Iteration 1 was built as a working website and completed on 10 October 2026. It was the version used in the first user test in October 2026, reported in the After Design section.

AFTER DESIGN / USER TESTING

Three sessions, one build, three ways in

Iteration 1 was tested in three moderated sessions in October 2026, one per persona. Each session was screen- and audio-recorded, then transcribed and cleaned for readability. The sessions were run by different team members and did not follow one script; the table records how each one ran, because that changes what its results can show.

Session	Participant	How it ran	Rating
1 Facilitator: Rui Meng Tong	Ben, 21. The Social Explorer; also interviewed in the research phase.	Think-aloud. Free exploration, then two tasks: find a club he would join, and find a club at a time that suits him and compare it. The facilitator answered questions as they came up.	7–8 / 10
2 Facilitator: Himani Rakesh Amin	Participant 2, a senior student in a folk-music club. Matches the Liv persona.	14 October, about 41 min. The site was demonstrated first, then one task: “go and join a club”. Focus on fonts and colour; a green VUW heading was shown near the end.	Not asked
3 Facilitators: Fanfu, Adam	Theo. The Advance Planner.	About 25 min. Free exploration of two visual versions, then three tasks: compare two clubs, fit a club around a timetable, and try a club with none in mind.	About 9 / 10

Which tasks each session covered

TASK	BEN	LIV	THEO
T1 Find an activity that fits my available time	●	○	●
T2 Decide whether a particular session suits me	●	○	●
T3 Prepare for my first visit	●	●	○
T4 Check the latest arrangements before attending again		○	○
T5 Explore an activity I’ve heard about		○	○

● given as a task · ○ came up during exploration or discussion, not as a task

Limits. Session 2 began with a demonstration, so it cannot show whether features are found unaided; the participant pointed this out herself. In sessions 1 and 3 the facilitators sometimes explained features (the pile, where to join), which is noted where it affects a result. No session gave T4 as a task. Ratings were asked differently and are not comparable.

AFTER DESIGN / TASK RESULTS

Finding and deciding worked. Joining did not.

Results by task, across the three sessions. “With help” means the participant got there only after a facilitator pointed the way.

Task	Result	What happened
T1 Fits my time	**Worked** pile needed a prompt	Ben saved two clubs and compared their times in the pile: “I can easily compare the times.” Theo found “Thursday, 6 to 8 pm, right at the top” and asked to export it to his calendar. Asked to compare two clubs, Theo first said he would open browser tabs; he used the pile only after it was suggested.
T2 Suits me	**Worked**	Ben: “just by looking at these interactives I can tell in less than a minute whether this is for me.” Theo: “Once I am on the club page, it is pretty straightforward.” Both found the text heavy: Ben called this-week.txt “all clumped”; Theo thought two windows were both about what is coming up.
T3 First visit	**Failed unaided**	Ben had to ask “How do I join?” and was told. Liv found the club’s email but: “if I’m a new student, I don’t know that’s how you join a club.” Both asked for a sign-up form on the page. Theo reached the contact details from the top of the page without help.
T4 Latest plan	**Not tested** content problem found	No session gave T4 as a task. Liv, a VicFolk member, saw that the page was wrong: “they don’t even meet Thursdays, they meet Tuesdays”, and not in those rooms. Theo: “I have gone expecting something to be happening when it was not.”
T5 Heard about	**Mixed**	Liv looked for the debating club by typing “debate”; Vic Debsoc did not appear, because search only matched names. Theo, with no club in mind, scrolled the list and picked by interest: “ukulele, drums and dancing”.

EASE-OF-USE RATINGS

Ben: 7–8 / 10, “it’s the details, the sizing and the organisation”. Theo: about 9 / 10, apart from “four or five” clicks to hit moving targets. Liv was not asked.

VISUAL VERSIONS

Liv and Theo both preferred the green VUW heading to the black homepage. Theo: “This version at least feels like it belongs to the same school.”

Twelve findings from three sessions

Findings merged across the sessions and numbered F1–F12; the heuristic evaluation and the recommendations refer back to these numbers. Severity: **H** blocks a task · **M** slows or confuses · **L** minor or a request.

#		FINDING	BEN	LIV	THEO
F1	H	**No way to join on the page.** Emailing the club is not obviously "joining".	●	●	
F2	H	**"Catch" is not understood.** "They're not fish." Theo expected a row click to open the club.	●	●	○
F3	H	**Club details are wrong or missing,** and clubs cannot update them. VicFolk's day and rooms were out of date.		●	●
F4	M	**Things look clickable but are not:** homepage phrases and "what's on", window lights, tick boxes.	○	●	●
F5	M	**The moving posters get in the way:** hard to click, hard to read past.	○	●	●
F6	M	**Windows are hard to tell apart,** and this-week.txt is one long block.	●	○	●
F7	M	**The pile is small and easy to miss.**	●	●	○
F8	M	**The black homepage does not feel like VUW;** the green version was preferred.		●	●
F9	M	**Video sound starts without asking** ("stressful… because they're loud").	○	●	
F10	M	**Search misses everyday names:** "debate" did not find Vic Debsoc.		●	
F11	L	**The golem distracts,** and its follow mode and long-distance jumps are unexplained.	●	●	
F12	L	**Requests:** calendar export (Theo), campus filter and moderated reviews (Liv), a person icon on members' quotes (Ben).	○	○	○

● raised directly · ○ related comment or behaviour. Nine of the twelve findings were raised directly by at least two participants.

Nielsen heuristic evaluation of Iteration 1

The Iteration 1 build checked against Nielsen's ten usability heuristics [6]. This is my evaluation; the evidence for each problem is the finding it links to on the previous page.

Heuristic	What works	Where it breaks	Severity · finding
H1 Visibility of system status	The filter bar says "2 of 6 match · 2 without a published time".	Saving gives little feedback, and the pile is easy to miss.	**M** F7
H2 Match with the real world	Times read like a timetable: "Thu 6pm · SU217".	Labels use the designer's words, not students': "catch", "first-time.note", "AGM".	**H** F2
H3 User control and freedom	The golem only follows when asked; the pile survives a refresh.	Sound starts on hover; ticks cannot be undone; the golem's jumps are unexplained.	**M** F9 · F11
H4 Consistency and standards	Every club page uses the same windows in the same places.	Window lights and "what's on" look active but do nothing.	**M** F4
H5 Error prevention	Each meeting line says when it was last checked.	Out-of-date details can send a student out on the wrong night.	**H** F3
H6 Recognition rather than recall	One window per question, each named like a file.	The windows look alike, so students guess which one holds what.	**M** F6
H7 Flexibility and efficiency of use	One-click save; the golem can set a filter or open a page.	Moving posters slow clicking; no calendar export or campus filter.	**M** F5 · F12
H8 Aesthetic and minimalist design	Posters and the golem give the site character: "I like the vibes of it."	Posters cover text; this-week.txt mixes three kinds of content; the black homepage does not feel like VUW.	**M** F5 · F6 · F8
H9 Recognise, diagnose and recover from errors	Clubs with no time are labelled, not hidden.	A search with no results gives no reason or suggestion.	**M** F10
H10 Help and documentation	first-time.note and say-hi.mail sit beside the task.	Nothing on the page says how to join.	**H** F1

Judgement: H1, H6 and H9 hold up best; H2, H5 and H10 carry the three high-severity findings. Overall, Iteration 1 helps students find a club and decide whether it suits them (T1, T2), but stops one step short of acting on it (T3) and cannot keep its information right (T4).

AFTER DESIGN / RECOMMENDATIONS

What Iteration 2 should keep, and what it should fix

Iteration 1 gets students from “I’d like to come” to “I know where to go”. The next step is “I know how to start”. These recommendations come from the findings and the evaluation; how Iteration 2 answers them belongs to the Iteration 2 report.

Keep

Valued by at least two participants.

- **Pictures and videos first.** Ben judged a club from a video’s sound alone.
- **Saving clubs to compare.** “A little shopping cart of clubs” (Liv).
- **Day filters and times on every row.** All three used or praised them.
- **One club page for everything.** Theo learned the second page from the first.
- **The golem,** made quieter. Entertaining, but distracting at times.
- **Real, current club content.** It is what let Liv catch an error.

Fix, in this order

Highest severity first.

1. **A way to join on the club page** (F1).
2. **Students’ words, not the designer’s** (F2).
3. **Details that stay correct,** which needs clubs involved (F3).
4. **Controls and windows that look like what they do** (F4, F6).
5. **A pile students notice** (F7).
6. **Less distraction, same character:** posters, sound, golem (F5, F9, F11).
7. **A look that belongs to VUW** (F8) and **search that knows everyday names** (F10).

Requests (F12) are recorded but not a priority.

CHANGE HOW WE TEST

Liv: “Here’s our website, I’m not going to teach you how it works unless you ask.” No demonstration, one task read out at a time, the same script in every session.

COVER EVERY TASK

No session gave T4 as a task. The next round should include all five user tasks, so that T3 and T4 can be compared with Iteration 1.

How this section was made

Tools

Wireframes were drawn in Excalidraw. The prototype was built with React 19, TypeScript and Vite, with hand-written CSS. Screenshots are taken from the Iteration 1 build (commit of 10 October 2026) at 1440 × 900 and 390 × 844.

AI use

Cursor (AI-assisted coding) supported prototype development and drafting of this section. I checked all output against the transcripts and the prototype. AI output is not user research evidence; every quotation and observation comes from the interviews and user test transcripts.

Sources

[1] SWEN303 Group 4, cleaned interview transcripts: Liv, Theo and Ben, 2026.

[2] SWEN303 Group 4, Personas, User Journey, User Tasks and Observations documents, 2026.

[3] SWEN303 Group 4, Wireframes (Excalidraw), 2026.

[4] Club content and media from the public pages and videos of VUCC, VicFolk, VUWTC, Vic Debsoc, Mukume Taiko and Vic Uke; credits are shown on each video in the prototype.

[5] SWEN303 Group 4, Iteration 1 user test transcripts: Session 1 (Ben), Session 2 (Liv persona), Session 3 (Theo), October 2026.

[6] J. Nielsen, “10 Usability Heuristics for User Interface Design,” Nielsen Norman Group, 1994, updated 2020.